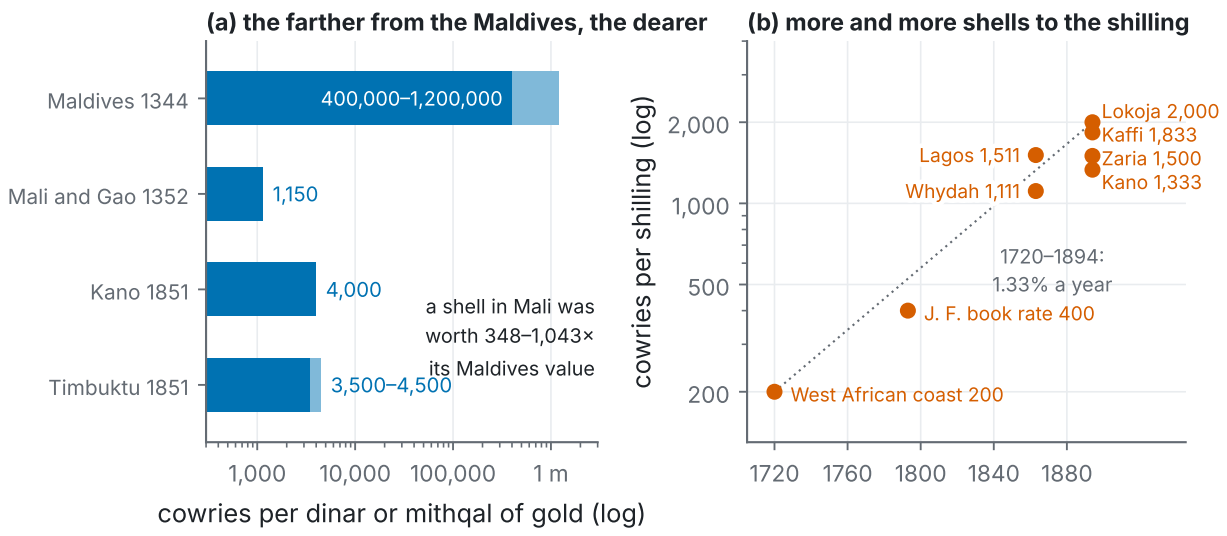
(a) the farther from the Maldives, the dearer
Maldives 1344
400,000–1,200,000
Mali and Gao 1352
1,150
Kano 1851
4,000
Timbuktu 1851
3,500–4,500
a shell in Mali was worth 348–1,043× its Maldives value
1,000
10,000
100,000
1 m
cowries per dinar or mithqal of gold (log)
(b) more and more shells to the shilling
cowries per shilling (log)
2,000
1,000
500
200
Lokoja 2,000
Kaffi 1,833
Zaria 1,500
Kano 1,333
Lagos 1,511
Whydah 1,111
1720–1894:
1.33% a year
J. F. book rate 400
West African coast 200
1720
1760
1800
1840
1880